

OrchidApp

Prepare OrchidApp for First Use

First-run setup checklist for Windows

Applies to: Windows 11

User guide

Use this guide after OrchidApp has been installed or upgraded using the Windows installer, and OrchidApp opens from the Start Menu or Desktop shortcut.

It shows the minimum setup needed before adding plants to the collection.

Before you start

You only need to do this setup once.

You can add more plant groups, species / hybrids, growing locations and growth media later from Setup.

Quick checklist

- Start OrchidApp for the first time and wait for setup to complete.
- Open Setup from the Home page.
- Add at least one plant group, also called a genus.
- Add at least one species / hybrid under that genus.
- Add the growing locations and growth media you use.
- Return to Home. OrchidApp is then ready for adding plants.

Step-by-step setup

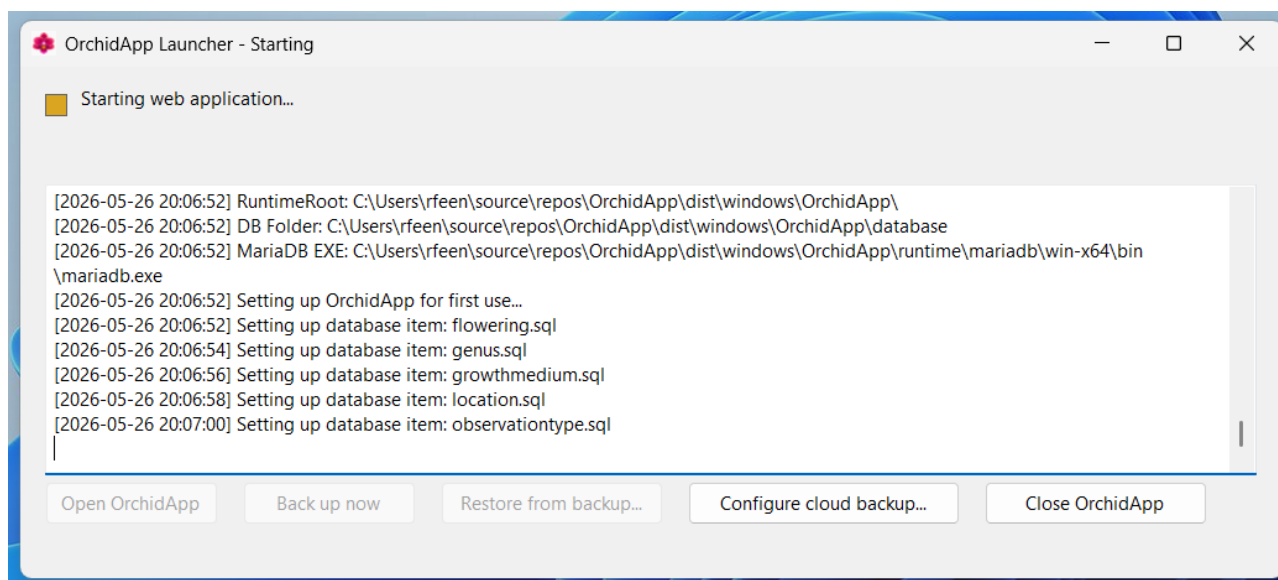
1. Start OrchidApp

Launch OrchidApp from the Start Menu or Desktop shortcut.

The OrchidApp Launcher opens first. On the first run, OrchidApp may need to prepare the local database and supporting files. This may take a few minutes.

Wait until the launcher finishes and OrchidApp opens in your browser.

Keep the OrchidApp Launcher window open while using OrchidApp.



First-use performance note

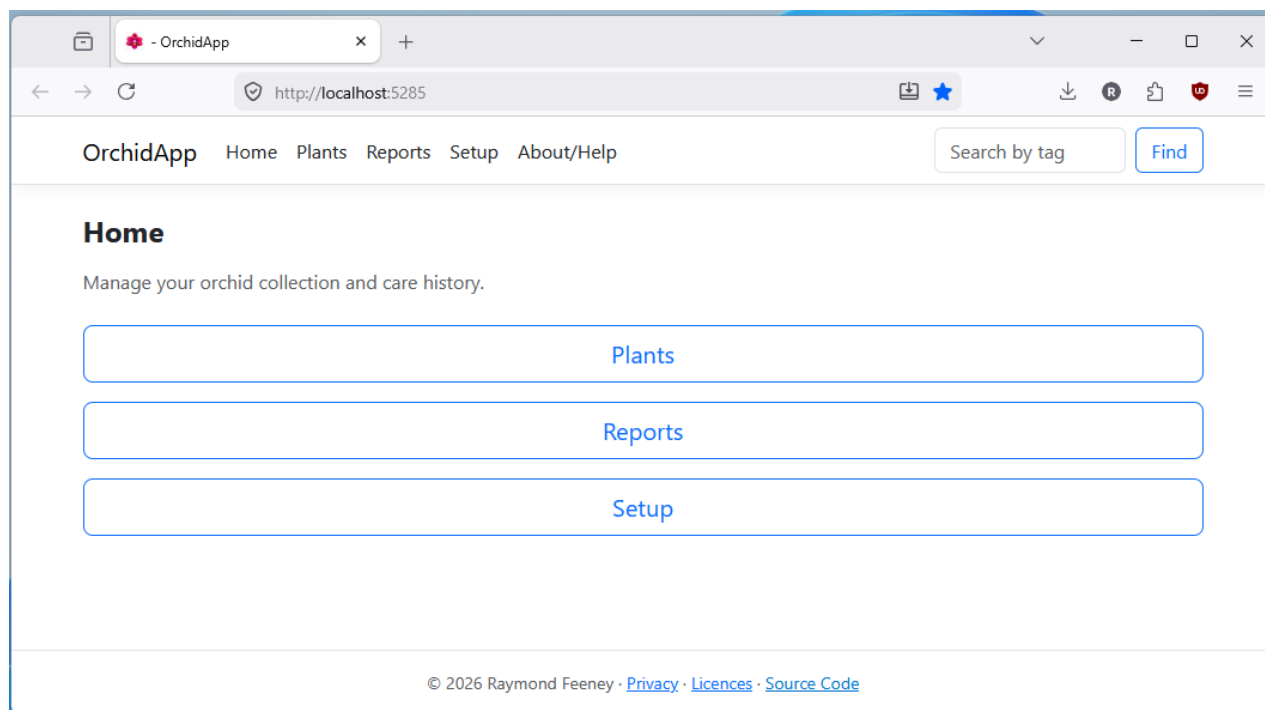
The first few pages may feel a little slower when OrchidApp has just started.

This is normal. OrchidApp prepares parts of the app as they are first used, so it often feels quicker after a short while.

2. Open Setup

On the Home page, select **Setup**.

Setup is where the basic lists are prepared before plants are added.



3. Choose what to set up first

The Setup page groups the main things OrchidApp needs:

- plant groups, also called genera
- species / hybrids
- growing locations
- growth media

Start with **Plant groups (Genera)** because species / hybrids belong inside a plant group.

OrchidApp Home Plants Reports Setup About/Help

Search by tag Find

Setup

Define the plant groups (Genera), species / hybrids and locations

Before adding plants, you should define the plant groups (**genera**, singular: genus) and the **species or hybrids** (varieties) in your collection, as well as the locations where you keep them.

Plant groups (Genera)

Species / Hybrids (varieties)

Growing locations (Greenhouse, garden, etc.)

Growth media (soil, bark, etc.)

← Back

4. Add a plant group

A plant group is formally called a genus.

Examples include:

- Cattleya
- Phalaenopsis
- Dendrobium

Select **Plant groups (Genera)**, then select **Add genus**.

Plant groups (Genera)

The main botanical groups your plants belong to

A plant group is formally called a **genus**. Examples include Phalaenopsis and Cattleya. Each genus only needs to be added once.

Add genus

Select a genus to view or edit its details.

← Back

5. Enter the genus details

Enter the genus name.

Notes are optional but useful for general care reminders that apply to the group.

Complete the details you require, then select **Add genus**.

Add genus

Create a new botanical group for your plants

A plant group is formally called a **genus**. For example: Phalaenopsis, Cattleya or Dendrobium. Each genus only needs to be added once.

Genus name

Enter the botanical genus name.

Dendrobium

Notes

Optional notes about this plant group.

Add genus

← Back

6. Check the genus has been added

After saving, the genus is confirmed and select **Back** to return to the list.

OrchidApp Home Plants Reports Setup About/Help Search by tag Find

Dendrobium

Genus details

Genus name	Dendrobium
Notes	—

[Edit genus](#)

[Deactivate genus](#)

[← Back](#)

It appears in the Plant groups list.

Select it later if you need to view or edit its details.

OrchidApp Home Plants Reports Setup About/Help Search by tag Find

Plant groups (Genera)

The main botanical groups your plants belong to

A plant group is formally called a **genus**. Examples include Phalaenopsis and Cattleya. Each genus only needs to be added once.

[Add genus](#)

Select a genus to view or edit its details.

[Dendrobium](#)

[← Back](#)

7. Open Species / Hybrids

Return to Setup and select **Species / Hybrids**.

Species and registered hybrids define the full botanical names used for plants. Note that a default Species / Hybrid has been created for your Genus. This is for all plants are of the genus but you do not have identified as a species or hybrid.

When you identify a plant at a later date by species or hybrid you can edit the plant to have the correct identification.

Species / Hybrids

Botanical names within each genus

Each genus contains one or more species or registered hybrids. These define the full botanical name of your plants.

Add species / hybrid

Select a species / hybrid to view or edit its details.

Dendrobium



Dendrobium sp. (genus placeholder)

← Back

8. Add a species or hybrid

Select **Add species / hybrid**.

Choose the genus first, then enter either a species name or a hybrid name.

Enter one name only.

You may also add a representative image and notes.

Add species / hybrid

Create a botanical name within a genus

A plant belongs to one genus and is identified by either a species or a registered hybrid. Enter one name only.

Genus

Select the genus this species or hybrid belongs to.

Dendrobium

Species name

Leave blank if adding a hybrid.

Hybrid name

Leave blank if adding a species.

Berry Oda

9. Save the species / hybrid

Complete the form and select **Add species / hybrid**.

Representative images and notes are optional, but they make the list easier to recognise later.

Add species / hybrid

Create a botanical name within a genus

A plant belongs to one genus and is identified by either a species or a registered hybrid. Enter one name only.

Genus

Select the genus this species or hybrid belongs to.

Dendrobium

Species name

Leave blank if adding a hybrid.

Hybrid name

Leave blank if adding a species.

Berry Oda

Representative image

Optional. Helps with visual identification.

Browse... berry-oda.png

Growth notes

Optional notes about growth characteristics.

Flowers every year - winter It thrives in bright, indirect light, prefers cooler temperatures, and enjoys a slight winter rest to encourage blooming. Thrives in intermediate conditions, but can withstand cool temperatures and appreciates a winter drop,

Notes

Optional notes about this species or hybrid.

The hybrid is a cross between Dendrobium kingianum and Dendrobium Mini Pearl.

← Back

Add species / hybrid

10. Confirm the species / hybrid

After saving, the details page shows the genus, name, notes and image.

From here you can edit the record or go back to the list.

Dendrobium Berry Oda

Species / hybrid details

Genus	Dendrobium
Hybrid name	Berry Oda
Growth notes	Flowers every year - winter It thrives in bright, indirect light, prefers cooler temperatures, and enjoys a slight winter rest to encourage blooming. Thrives in intermediate conditions, but can withstand cool temperatures and appreciates a winter drop, with some recommending a minimum of around 10oC to encourage blooming. Feeding: Feed with a balanced fertilizer in summer; switch to a bloom booster in autumn, and cease feeding in late autumn to prepare for a winter rest.
Notes	The hybrid is a cross between Dendrobium kingianum and Dendrobium Mini Pearl.



Edit species / hybrid

Deactivate species / hybrid

← Back

What to do next

Repeat the same basic process from Setup for:

- growing locations, such as greenhouse, windowsill, garden or grow tent
- growth media, such as bark, moss, leca or mixed media

Once those are set up, return to Home and start adding plants from the Plants section.

Keep the setup simple

You do not need to add everything on day one.

Add enough information to start using OrchidApp, then improve the setup as your collection grows.

Optional reference: editing later

The first-run checklist deliberately avoids every edit screen. Everything can be edited for correction.

Use the edit pages later if you need to correct notes, replace an image or deactivate an item that should no longer be used for new plants.

Edit species / hybrid

Dendrobium

Changing the species or hybrid name will update all plants that use this name.

HybridName

Use only for spelling corrections or recognised taxonomic updates.

Berry Oda

GrowthNotes

Optional notes about growth characteristics.

Flowers every year - winter It thrives in bright, indirect light, prefers cooler temperatures, and enjoys a slight winter rest to encourage blooming. Thrives in intermediate conditions, but can withstand cool temperatures and appreciates a winter drop,

TaxonNotes

Optional notes about this species or hybrid.

The hybrid is a cross between Dendrobium kingianum and Dendrobium Mini Pearl.

Replace image

Uploading a new image will replace the current one.

Browse...

No file selected.

Save species / hybrid

← Back

Setup complete

OrchidApp is ready for adding plants when you have added:

- at least one plant group / genus
- at least one species / hybrid
- the growing locations you use
- the growth media you use

You can then continue with:

03 - Add and Manage Plants in OrchidApp